

OPERATION NORTHERN GLASS

SCENARIO TITLE: OPERATION NORTHERN GLASS

DATE: 08 FEB 1984

DIRECTOR BRIEF:

NATO sensors detect unusual Soviet activity across the Norwegian Sea during a major winter exercise. A submarine contact, intermittent radar emissions, a high-altitude aircraft, and conflicting human reports may describe one coordinated operation or several unrelated tests.

OBJECTIVE:

Determine whether the activity is preparation for a strategic strike, a deception operation, or routine experimentation. Recommend one NATO response that protects readiness without causing unnecessary escalation.

HANDLING NOTE

This document contains fictional facts for a multi-agent training game. Each marked dossier is routed only to its named specialist. Facts should not be supplemented with outside knowledge.

[SUBMARINE DOSSIER]

- [p. 2] A Victor-class attack submarine left its normal exercise box twelve hours early and moved toward a NATO acoustic-array maintenance corridor.
- [p. 2] The contact slowed below five knots, crossed behind a seamount, and was lost for forty-seven minutes.
- [p. 2] Hydrophones detected two short metallic transients before contact loss. Analysts cannot distinguish equipment deployment from normal hull noise.
- [p. 2] No torpedo-door noise, emergency traffic, explosion, or distress signal was detected.
- You have no access to ELINT, aircraft, or HUMINT reporting.

[ELINT DOSSIER]

- [p. 2] A Soviet coastal radar used a narrow-beam tracking mode on three NATO patrol routes, but each illumination lasted under nine seconds.
- [p. 2] The emitter changed frequency according to a pattern not present in the NATO reference library.
- [p. 2] Two bursts occurred while no NATO aircraft was inside the radar's expected line of sight.
- [p. 2] Maintenance calibration, anti-jamming trials, and deliberate signaling remain viable explanations.
- You have no access to submarine, aircraft, or HUMINT reporting.

[AIR DOSSIER]

- [p. 3] A modified Tu-95 flew north without its normal tanker support and approached the Greenland-Iceland-UK gap.
- [p. 3] Reconnaissance images show two unfamiliar pods beneath the wings; resolution is insufficient to identify weapons or sensors.
- [p. 3] The aircraft turned away immediately after a NATO fighter radar acquired it and never crossed sovereign airspace.
- [p. 3] Its route overlapped the radar illumination area but not the last confirmed submarine position.
- You have no access to submarine, ELINT, or HUMINT reporting.

[HUMINT DOSSIER]

- [p. 3] A reliable dockworker reports that technicians loaded cable-handling equipment onto the submarine tender before departure.
- [p. 3] A new source claiming access to Northern Fleet plans says the operation is a rehearsal for cutting NATO seabed sensors. The source has not been independently verified.
- [p. 3] A diplomatic contact heard that Moscow expects NATO to overreact to a deliberately visible exercise.
- [p. 3] The new source and diplomatic contact may both have received information from the same Soviet briefing officer.
- You have no access to submarine, ELINT, or aircraft reporting.

[END DOSSIER]

END OF FICTIONAL SCENARIO